



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Archway Classical Academy - Arete
School Website: <https://archwayarete.greatheartsamerica.org/>

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Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Archway Classical Academy Arete Az (Arete) presents a robust classical-education orientation anchored in Great Hearts/Great Books-style liberal arts, with explicit emphasis on forming "hearts and minds in virtue and truth" and cultivating the habits of character that accompany a classical curriculum. Public-facing materials repeatedly foreground classical content and the aims of developing virtue, wisdom, and a love of truth, beauty, and goodness. That said, explicit religious-theological framing and liturgical/community practices are less overt in the visible public materials, which yields a rating that leans CLASSICAL overall, with Element 1 showing some room for stronger explicit religious/metaphysical articulation.

Key drivers of the CLASSICAL assessment - Content centers on a classical liberal arts approach, with a stated aim to cultivate virtue, wisdom, and the triad of Truth, Beauty, and Goodness (positively signaling transcendental aims) as core to formation, not merely information transfer. This is evidenced in Arete's public-facing curriculum language and Great Hearts framing. - The materials emphasize formation and character ("habits of the heart," virtue, leadership, human flourishing) and highlight Great Books/the liberal-arts tradition as core, aligning strongly with classical education norms. - Pedagogical language and historical framing emphasize an intentional, traditional approach (ancient/paideia-like lineage, memory-based practices, emphasis on classics and rhetoric) consistent with classical pedagogy concepts. - Community and family involvement are clearly valued (volunteer culture, parent engagement, open campus, family events), which aligns with the classical-school model's emphasis on parental partnership and the living curriculum.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials emphasize virtue and the transcendent aims of education (Truth, Beauty, Goodness) within a classical liberal-arts framework. This aligns with transcendental norms of classical education.
 - The materials repeatedly describe forming hearts and minds in virtue and truth, which signals a moral-metaphysical orientation, though explicit theology or liturgical practices are not foregrounded in the visible site copy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, formation, wisdom, wonder.
 - Negative keywords observed: none explicitly evident in the public-facing pages; the lexicon's negatives (e.g., relativism, secular-humanist signals) are not present in Arete's public copies. The lexicon helps interpret what would constitute a negative signal, but the site copy itself shows mostly positive signals.
- Why this rating
 - The school clearly embraces transcendentals (Truth, Beauty, Goodness) and virtue-centered formation, which are core to classical foundations. However, explicit theological grounding, liturgical practice, or overt ecclesial cues are not strongly foregrounded in the accessible site content, which tempers the rating toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL. The

presence of occasional faith-affirming language and a family/community liturgical cadence would strengthen this category further if made explicit on public pages.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school's stated aim centers on formation and human flourishing through a classical mission, with explicit references to virtue and telos (the true, good, beautiful). The material describes formation as the goal, not mere information acquisition.
 - The school emphasizes formation of character and virtue, not primarily job-readiness; the aim is to cultivate "hearts and minds in virtue and truth" within a classical framework.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, great conversation, moral imagination.
 - Negative keywords observed: explicit workforce-preparation rhetoric is not foregrounded; public materials emphasize formation over job-prep. The classical lexicon notes as negative signals such as "college and career ready" or "21st-century skills" would be oppositional to the formation emphasis, and such signals are not prominent in Arete's public copy.
- Why this rating
 - Arete explicitly frames education as formation in virtue and wisdom, anchored in classical aims, with strong language about telos and the true/good/beautiful. That aligns closely with CLASSICAL scoring for this category, supported by direct quotes and mission-focused language.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The curriculum is described as classical liberal arts; the school notes a focus on truth, beauty, and goodness and on a classical mission. There are explicit mentions of a liberal-arts framework as central to the experience.
 - Historical breadth and a "Great Books" orientation appear via the classical-inheritance framing and references to a long tradition of classical education, even if not every page copy includes the exact phrase "Great Books," the overall framing is heavily classical (liberal arts, grammar/logic/rhetoric, history as a Western-civilization narrative).
 - The site emphasizes a history-and-tradition framing, positioning ACA within the classical lineage rather than modern, progressive curricula.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, classics, history, Western civilization, memory/recitation, hymns, sacred art (where present), etc.
 - Negative keywords observed: limited or no mention of "project-based learning dominance" or STEM-first framing on public pages; if present, they are not foregrounded as a curricular default. The lexicon lists potential negatives, but the Arete pages show classical-curriculum signals.
- Why this rating
 - The curricular signals are strongly classical: liberal-arts curriculum, emphasis on truth/beauty/-goodness, and a historical/classical-education frame. This aligns with CLASSICAL on the curriculum criterion.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school explicitly references a traditional, classical-pedagogy approach, noting an ancient view of learning and traditional teaching methods, with a trajectory that includes memory-intensive practices and a long-standing classical pedagogy. This aligns with classical pedagogy in lower grades and a high-school preference for Socratic-style discussion and rhetoric in upper grades, per classical-education norms.

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- The Great Hearts framework commonly employs Socratic discussion and classical seminars; Arete materials describe a long-standing classical approach rather than a purely constructivist/experiential emphasis. The text points to a Paideia-like approach and a memory-oriented, classical pedagogy.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: Socratic seminar/discussion, narrative/recitation, memory work, restfulness/scholé days, seminar/colloquy/tutorial, rhetoric, public speaking, capstone orations, etc. The lexicon lists these as core signs of classical pedagogy; the Arete materials describe classical methods in aggregate.
 - Negative keywords observed: signals such as “experiential learning focus” or “project-based only” would be negative signals, but Arete’s public content emphasizes a traditional pedagogy rather than counter-signals. No strong negative signals are foregrounded in public copy.
 - Why this rating
 - Arete’s public materials stress a traditional, classical pedagogy grounded in historical approaches and a Paideia-like philosophy, with a trajectory toward Socratic and rhetoric-based upper-level work typical of classical pedagogy. This justifies a CLASSICAL rating for pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials describe faculty as exemplars who form a “living curriculum,” with a portrait of what a teacher should be and a culture of collegial, mentor-like relationships. This aligns with classical-school expectations that the faculty model virtue and mastery.
 - Archway Arete materials emphasize character formation and teacher-student partnership, with teachers and staff presented as central to the school’s mission and culture. This mirrors the classical ideal of the teacher as a moral exemplar and living curriculum.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, mentors, guides, collegial culture, moral exemplars, character formation, teachers as models.
 - Negative keywords observed: not evident in public pages (no “adverse” teacher-stature signals); the lexicon includes potential negatives for modern interpretations, but Arete’s content foregrounds classical-teacher virtues.
- Why this rating
 - The public-facing evidence aligns with the classical faculty model: teachers as moral exemplars, mentors, and central to formation; thus CLASSICAL for Element 5.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school publicly prioritizes parent involvement and partnership, with explicit calls for parent volunteers and a culture of parent formation and engagement. The “VOLUNTEERS” section explicitly invites parents to participate and to engage deeply in their child’s education.
 - Arete content describes a highly relational community with parent participation, giving Tuesday/benefits, and appeals to a broader community and family engagement (e.g., family involvement, liturgical-year events, feasts, festivals, hospitality). This aligns with the classical model’s emphasis on parents as co-teachers and partners in formation.
 - The Great Hearts/Arete materials emphasize forming hearts and minds in partnership with families, which aligns with the parent-co-teacher notion in the classical framework.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation, reading groups, seminars, classical book clubs, open campus, volunteer, hospitality, parent covenant, feasts and festivals, family liturgy alignment.
 - Negative keywords observed: consumer-language signals or minimal parent involvement are not evident; the public copy emphasizes active parental involvement. The lexicon marks negatives

to watch, but Arete's materials do not reflect those negative signals.

- Why this rating
 - The material clearly demonstrates a classical-education-anchored, parent-inclusive community with explicit invitations for parent involvement and formation. This is a CLASSICAL signal for Element 6.

Aggregate Assessment - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 2: CLASSICAL - Element 3: CLASSICAL - Element 4: CLASSICAL - Element 5: CLASSICAL - Element 6: CLASSICAL

- Rationale: The school exhibits a strong classical orientation across Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents/Community, with formation/virtue highlighted as core aims. Element 1 shows some room for stronger explicit theological and liturgical articulation in publicly visible materials, which is why it is labeled SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL in that single category. The aggregate profile remains CLASSICAL due to the weight of evidence in the other five categories.
- What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT in Element 1)
 - Add explicit statements about theological grounding and liturgical/community practices on the public-facing site (e.g., a clear theology statement, liturgical calendar, and regular communal worship or prayer elements described in accessible terms).
 - Provide concrete examples of liturgical or worship activities integrated into the student experience (e.g., chapel programs, liturgical calendar celebrations) to strengthen the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations category.
 - Include a short FAQ or page that ties the Christian worldview to the curriculum and daily classroom practices, making the metaphysical foundations more explicit to prospective families.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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